

August

20



1999

Off the danger list

The peregrine falcon was removed from a list of endangered species by the US Fish and Wildlife Service. Its formerly declining populations had recovered thanks to protection provided by the Endangered Species Act and a ban on harmful pesticides.

Born this day

1992 Demi Lovato, US singer and actor. They began their career on television before topping the charts as a pop singer. Lovato is a campaigner for the LGBTQ+ community.

1922

Women's World Games

The first international competition in track and field sports for women was held in Paris, France. About 15,000 spectators gathered to watch the female athletes in action.



Also on this day

636 The **Battle of Yarmouk** resulted in victory for Arab forces, bringing an end to the Byzantine Empire in Syria.

1619 The first group of enslaved people from Africa arrived at the British colony of Virginia in North America.

1897 British doctor **Ronald Ross** found the parasite that causes the disease malaria in the stomach of a female *Anopheles* mosquito.



Climate strike

Fifteen-year-old Greta Thunberg skipped school to sit outside the Swedish parliament in Stockholm, with a homemade placard announcing a "school strike for climate". Her campaigns seeking action to tackle climate change have sparked a global movement.

2018

